LETTER FROM THE EDITOR-IN-CHIEF

It's only those who appreciate the performance metrics of a high-stakes on-field performance, who will truly comprehend the demands of speed. Whether you're enjoying the raw explosive power of cricketing action or the refined technical precision of a luxury car, the thrill and the challenge is the same. It is this meeting ground of two passions that this issue of ***Spice*** celebrates with the Indian women's cricket team captain, Harmanpreet Kaur as cover star.

Rhythmic grace and aggressive pitch play aside, this is the captain who never stalls under pressure and led the Women in Blue to their maiden ICC trophy on Nov 2, 2025. While her astounding journey, from the gulleys and grounds of Moga in Punjab to the cricketing Hall of Fame, is one for the history books, Kaur explains how she knew that one trophy would prove to be the game-changer for women's cricket. The road to self-discovery and success has been long and arduous, but for now, it's time to relish the euphoria and the perks which come with it. Among the rewards she values most is her Mercedes GLS. "It was a dream and I purchased it in a day," she admits.

The German auto marque for its part, has done much to cater to its fan club by launching the Mercedes-Benz V-Class, after a hiatus of four years. It has been brought to India exclusively in the extra-long wheelbase configuration, alongside the next-gen CLA, which for the first time is electric only. Of course, EVs are staking their claim in the rapidly evolving world of luxury automobiles with next-level car systems, connectivity and built-in intelligence. At an approximate launch price of ₹10.37 crore, Ferrari has brought the brand-new 849 Testarossa to our shores, using a re-engineered mid-rear twin-turbo V8 setup combined with three electric motors, with total output at a staggering 1,050bhp, headlined by a 0 to 100kmph time of just 2.25 seconds, and a top speed of 330 kmph.

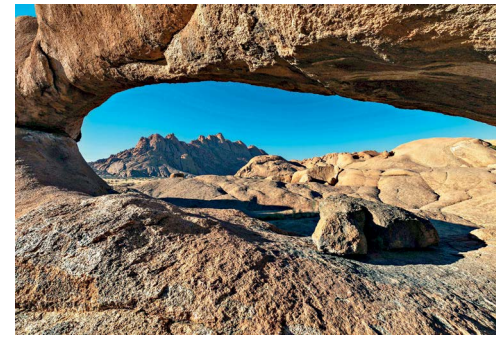
Speed undoubtedly thrills, but to the dogged luxury devotee, customised is the true coefficient of exclusivity. The bespoke programme of Rolls Royce is already a market leader in customised cars, the Goodwood carmaker has truly pushed the envelope with the introduction of its Coachbuild Collection. What this promises is a never-to-be-repeated Rolls-Royce, built entirely from scratch for that one customer, making the shape and silhouette 'entirely yours'.

If the entirely customised Rolls Royce is a conversation starter in the world of luxury cars, the return of 'conversation pits' has turned the narrative when it comes to interior design. Leading interior designers and architects explain how these sunken living spaces are evolving from their 20th-century roots into refined, reimagined pits with sleek lines, using sophisticated materials and smart technology.

While technology may dominate the season's essentials, when it comes to celebration, liquid pleasures still lead the charge. Euan Kennedy, one of the custodians of The Macallan, shares the secrets of the storied brand's whisky-making heritage. Here's toasting the legends and beyond!







The Timeless Collection from The Macallan (Top); A 'one-off', Rolls Royce from their recently created, invitation-only Coachbuild Collection (Middle); Namibia is on this year's travel wishlist (Above)

(Aroon Purie)